

Wednesday, 29 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Clear

34° 21°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

29° 18°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

24° 17°

GLASGOW

Rain

19° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 Dozens of grieving families have shared their harrowing experiences at the sentencing hearing of a funeral director who treated the deceased 'like a piece of meat'.**

Robert Bush is accused of various offences related to his funeral business. The court heard emotional testimonies from those affected by his actions.

CRIME · UK

- 2 A man has been found guilty of murdering two men whose bodies were discovered in woods.**

James Desborough had previously admitted to preventing the lawful burial of Claudio Aquilino Daniel Coleman. The court case has concluded with a murder conviction.

CRIME · UK

- 3 The man jailed for killing Charlotte Brown in a 2018 speedboat incident has now admitted a violent attack on another woman.**

Jack Shepherd, 38, was previously sentenced to 10 years for manslaughter. This new admission adds to his criminal record.

CRIME · UK

- 4 The head of the body set up to make tall buildings safer after the Grenfell tragedy says 'everyone failed' on Grenfell.**

Andy Roe leads the new organisation, working to prevent similar disasters. His comments highlight the systemic issues that led to the fire.

DISASTER · UK

- 5 Kemi Badenoch is calling for emergency legislation to stop an early release scheme for prisoners.**

Last week, Andy Burnham paused early release plans for September after backlash. Badenoch's intervention signals growing political concern over the issue.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1

Love Island UK has crowned its winners after a series filled with twists and turns.

For the first time ever, only three couples made it to the final. Fans are buzzing about the unexpected outcome and the winning pair.

ON AIR – What did you make of this year's Love Island final? Did the right couple win?

REALITY TV · TODAY

2

The trailer for the highly anticipated film 'Children of Blood and Bone' has dropped, featuring Cynthia Erivo and Damson Idris.

Based on Tomi Adeyemi's popular novel, the author herself has distanced herself from the blockbuster. It promises to be a big screen event.

ON AIR – Are you excited for 'Children of Blood and Bone'? Have you read the book?

FILM · COMING SOON

3

Pitbull fans have set a new Guinness World Record at his BST Hyde Park show.

Mr Worldwide's dedicated followers achieved the record for the largest gathering of people wearing bald caps. It was a truly unique spectacle!

ON AIR – What's the most unusual thing you've seen at a concert? Or maybe you've been part of a world record attempt?

MUSIC · EVENT

4

A notorious Cameroonian prison has made headlines by launching its own record label.

Inmates at New Bell prison are becoming mini-stars, recording songs and music videos from behind bars. It's a surprising development in the world of music.

ON AIR – What do you think about a prison having its own record label? A good way to rehabilitate, or something else entirely?

MUSIC · INTERNATIONAL

5

Rapper Aitch has revealed his sister inspired him to climb one of the world's toughest peaks.

He's been taking on various challenges to raise awareness and money for the Down's Syndrome Association. It's a fantastic cause and a testament to his dedication.

ON AIR – What's the biggest challenge you've ever taken on for charity? Or what cause is close to your heart?

CHARITY · UK

On the schedule

- 1 **Zinedine Zidane has officially been confirmed as the new head coach of the France national team.**
The former Real Madrid manager takes the reins of his home country's squad. Fans will be hoping he can bring his legendary success to the national side.

ON AIR – What do you think of Zidane taking over France? Can he lead them to glory?

FOOTBALL · INTERNATIONAL

- 2 **Southern Brave have held on to beat MI London in a thrilling finale to the Women's Hundred.**
Lauren Bell restricted MI London to just six runs in the final over, securing a nervy one-run victory. It was a nail-biting conclusion at the Utilita Bowl.

ON AIR – Did you watch the Women's Hundred final? What's your favourite cricket format?

CRICKET · UK

- 3 **Wales fly-half Gareth Anscombe is set to join Scarlets from Bayonne for the upcoming United Rugby Championship season.**
This marks Anscombe's third Welsh club, bringing his experience back to home soil. Fans will be eager to see him in action.

ON AIR – How important are these player transfers to the success of Welsh rugby? Will Anscombe make a big difference?

RUGBY · UK

- 4 **Champions Northampton will kick off the new Premiership season at home against Newcastle.**
The 2026-27 season schedule has been released, with Exeter also hosting Gloucester on the opening weekend. Rugby fans can start planning their trips.

ON AIR – Are you excited for the new Premiership rugby season? Who are you tipping for the title?

RUGBY · UK

- 5 **British number two Cameron Norrie has finally ended his six-match losing streak with a straight-set win.**
Norrie defeated Aleksandar Kovacevic, marking his first victory since April. It's a much-needed boost for the British tennis star.

ON AIR – How important is it for British tennis players to bounce back from a losing streak? Who are you following in the tennis world right now?

TENNIS · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Gardeners are finding joy in 'micro-gardening' – cultivating tiny plants in unexpected places.**
From teacups to old boots, people are creating charming miniature ecosystems, proving you don't need a huge plot to grow something lovely.
- 2 A recent trend sees people rediscovering the simple pleasure of 'analogue games' for social gatherings.**
Think classic board games and card decks, bringing friends and family together for screen-free fun and plenty of laughs.
- 3 Researchers are noting a rise in the popularity of 'quiet commuting' amongst city dwellers.**
Many are choosing to use their journey time for mindful observation or listening to podcasts, transforming a daily chore into a moment of calm reflection.
- 4 The delightful hobby of 'collecting interesting pebbles' from various holiday destinations is gaining traction.**
Each stone becomes a tangible memory of a trip, creating a unique and natural souvenir collection.
- 5 Experts are suggesting that 'having a designated 'thinking chair'' can boost creativity and problem-solving.**
A specific, comfortable spot dedicated to quiet contemplation can apparently help ideas flow more freely.
- 6 There's a growing appreciation for the soothing sounds of 'ambient café noise' for concentration.**
Many find the gentle hum of chatter and clinking cups creates a non-distracting background for focused work or reading.
- 7 A study highlights the 'mood-boosting power of opening curtains' as soon as you wake up.**
Exposing yourself to natural light early in the day can positively impact your circadian rhythm and overall well-being.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to remember where we put our keys?

ANSWER: LOOKING IN THE FRIDGE, 'JUST IN CASE'.

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a nice, hot cup of tea. What is it?

ANSWER: STIRRING IT AN EXACT NUMBER OF TIMES.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know those little 'secret talents' you possess, that perhaps nobody else really knows about?**
We're talking about those quirky, perhaps not very useful, but definitely unique skills you've got up your sleeve! What's your secret talent?
- **Think about those 'everyday objects' that you have a surprisingly specific way of organising or using.**
Perhaps it's how you arrange your spice rack, or the particular way you fold your towels. What everyday item do you have a peculiar ritual for?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, which helps them find nectar.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye.
- The dot over the letter 'i' is called a tittle.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.
- The longest place name in the world is Taumatawhakatangihangakoauauotamateaturipukakapikimaungahoronukupokaiwhenuakitanatahu, in New Zealand.
- A cloud can weigh over a million pounds.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- Bananas are technically berries, but strawberries are not.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is considered the toughest tongue twister in the English language.

On this day

Day 210 of the year, 155 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Lazarus of Bethany; Christian feast day: Lupus of Troyes; Christian feast day: Martha of Bethany (Catholic, Anglican, and Lutheran Church); Christian feast day: Mary of Bethany. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1958 — Simon Nye, English screenwriter and producer
- 1963 — Jim Beglin, Irish footballer and sportscaster
- 1966 — Sally Gunnell, English hurdler and sportscaster
- 1923 — Gordon Mitchell, American bodybuilder and actor (died 2003)
- 1953 — Patti Scialfa, American musician
- 1946 — Diane Keen, English actress
- 1969 — Timothy Omundson, American actor
- 1933 — Lou Albano, Italian-American wrestler, manager, and actor (died 2009)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1976 — In New York City, David Berkowitz (a.k.a. the "Son of Sam") kills one person and seriously wounds another in the first of a series of attacks.
- 2015 — The first piece of suspected debris from Malaysia Airlines Flight 370 is discovered on Réunion Island.
- 2021 — The International Space Station temporarily spins out of control, moving the ISS 45 degrees out of attitude, following an engine malfunction of Russian module Nauka.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2010 — An overloaded passenger ferry capsizes on the Kasai River in Bandundu Province, Democratic Republic of the Congo, resulting in at least 80 deaths.
- 1980 — Iran adopts a new "holy" flag after the Islamic Revolution.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1965 — Vietnam War: The first 4,000 101st Airborne Division paratroopers arrive in Vietnam, landing at Cam Ranh Bay.

1950 — Korean War: After four days, the No Gun Ri Massacre ends when the US Army 7th Cavalry Regiment is withdrawn.

- 1981 — After impeachment on June 21, Abolhassan Banisadr flees with Massoud Rajavi to Paris, in an Iranian Air Force Boeing 707, piloted by Colonel Behzad Moezzi, to form the National Council of Resistance of Iran.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 211 of the year, 154 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abdon and Sennen; Christian feast day: Blessed Edward Powell, Richard Fetherston and Thomas Abel; Christian feast day: Hatebrand; Christian feast day: María Natividad Venegas de la Torre. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — Frances de la Tour, English actress
- 1965 — Tim Munton, English cricketer
- 1970 — Christopher Nolan, English-American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1980 — Justin Rose, South African-English golfer
- 1963 — Lisa Kudrow, American actress and producer
- 1939 — Peter Bogdanovich, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter (died 2022)
- 1960 — Richard Linklater, American director and screenwriter
- 1971 — Christine Taylor, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1978 — The 730: Okinawa Prefecture changes its traffic on the right-hand side of the road to the left-hand side.
- 1980 — Vanuatu gains independence.
- 2003 — In Mexico, the last 'old style' Volkswagen Beetle rolls off the assembly line.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2012 — A power grid failure in Delhi leaves more than 300 million people without power in northern India.
- 1965 — U.S. president Lyndon B. Johnson signs the Social Security Act of 1965 into law, establishing Medicare and Medicaid.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 31 Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7 Once Upon a Time in a Cinema

FRI 14 Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie

FRI 21 Mutiny; The Bride!

FRI 28 Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4 Conjuring: Last Rites

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026

23 JUL — 2 AUG Commonwealth Games, Glasgow

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10 Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)